The Black Tactic and 10 Things I Want to Say to a Black Man

By Marion Amponsah and Jennifer Falu

INTRODUCTION

To have a good life, do you have to be white? Sometimes it seems so. . . Black and brown men are regularly stereotyped, silenced, and blamed for the oppression they face. And while any person with a shred of common sense knows that using the "N" word is not socially acceptable today, many words act as substitutes for the slur that has come to define race relations in America. These words and phrases are united by a hurtful message: Black people don't deserve to be treated with respect – they are and will always be the "other."

Thug, Inner-city, Ghetto, Oreo, Uppity, You people, Shady – all just words that have become America's coded language drowning in a sea of negative stereotypes. And often times, left with few alternatives, black males are pressured to adopt . . . The Black Tactic by Marion Amponsah

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The Black Tactic

Black males are often pressured and blackmailed by black males to act black.

To re-enact a lack of intelligence and beauty

But in turn fills the brain with that of being negligent and moody

The black tactic

Enact a crack addict with bad habits

Days later his back is in a jacked casket

That's what the blackmail sells

Not to mention almost endless years in a jail cell

They fail well

It's the white man's fault they blame and phrase well

They will never be independent

They will never be able to manage

They will never be able to speak proper English

Slang their disabled language

Bang, Bang, Bang, the shots are definitely capable from these black savages

Bandages loosely put on

Just years ago they were struggling with hardships but they

still face challenges

Bad their behavior never good

Shooting Hustling Killing

They all live in ghettos

They all live in projects

They all live in bad neighborhoods

Always the last

They remain in lower class

Confliction their nerves clash

Addiction to herbs and grass

From success exclude blacks

Their welfare is wrecked

Support from the government

Food stamps and welfare checks

Brains frail with no respect

Assured to be black is a much scarier life

They have thrown away their future burying light

Is this automatically a barrier?

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To have a good life I have to be white.

Why not reject the role or the character

Tell the directors

To live positive my skin doesn't have to be light or white

Acting black is impossible

It doesn't require becoming a Ghetto, Imprisoned, Violent,

Crack Addicted, being

Those are just the stereotypes!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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TRANSITION

In 1963 . . . . Martin Luther King spoke these visionary words: "I have a dream that my four little children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the color of their skin, but by the content of their character"

40 years later . . . have we achieved his dream? We've made progress . . . yes, but there is still so much negativity and criminal suspicion associated with being a black male. Skin color, for a black man, is like a personal prison, something he has no control over.

No one should be made to feel ashamed of being a black man – As Dr. King lamented over 40 years ago . . . each man should be judged based on the content of his character, and not just based on the color of his skin.

10 Things I Want to Say to a Black Man by Jennifer Falu.

10 Things I Want to Say to a Black Man

One, I wish I could place your arms in a box.

For those long winter nights where the warmth of a blanket just isn't enough.

Shop online for the cheapest time machine.

Travel back to a time where you were respected.

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Back to the beginning where God used your rib to create woman.

Two, your eyes tell a story that you hide behind Stunnah Shades.

Your ears, hidden behind Beats.

While girls are screaming for your attention wearing mini skirts, and tops that expose their wombs to a world that doesn't care about their babies.

Three, I apologize for the Soulja Boys, Chris Browns, and Wakas

Who call women materialistic female dogs, think it's okay to hit them, and thinks being hoodrich makes them real men.

I honor you, for standing up for what you believe in,

Especially since the rest of the world's belief system is slightly skewed.

Four, your voice is like thunder, sharp, with a low rumble,

as though demanding the attention of the closest ear.

Five, I'm sorry for the women who make you feel like less than a man.

Many of us compare you to the type of men who've abandoned us.

Six, you're beautiful, so beautiful that no female could ever take your place.

In a time where women have given up on you,

Just remember you were created in God's image.

So I look to you, and I see God's face

through eyes of a woman who shares your rib.

Seven, when I was born my father held me in the palm of his hand.

I admire you hands, they hold the secret to strength and peace.

Strength in the scars from years of hard work.

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Peace in the gentle way you hold the women that you love.

The same strength and peace that God had when he molded you.

Eight, when we get married, I'll mow the lawn, to show you just how much I disagree with the normal flow of things.

Forget about the grass allergy that would attack my immune system.

Let my love for you be the antihistamine that counteracts against the stereotypes.

Nine, my son will know his father from birth.

There's nothing more heartbreaking than a child who suffers from an absent father.

Not because he's absent minded, but because the mother is absent hearted.

Ten, never let anyone tell you that you're less than amazing.

Our families need you more now than ever.

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AWARD HISTORY

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